

Ngozi Harrison

(he/him)

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PhD Candidate in Information Studies, University of California, Los Angeles

Research Areas Information Science, Critical Data Studies, Statistics, Machine Learning,
Philosophy of Technology, Black Studies

EDUCATION

University of California, Los Angeles

Spring 2028 (expected)

Ph.D. Candidate in Information Studies

Dissertation: *Machine Learning Hesitant: Asymptotic Thinking, Data, and the Politics of Measurement*

Committee Members

Safiya Noble (Chair) – UCLA Information Studies, African American Studies, Gender Studies

André Brock – Georgia Tech, School of Literature, Media, and Communication

Steven Culpepper – University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign, Statistics

Miriam Posner – UCLA Information Studies, Digital Humanities

Sarah T. Roberts – UCLA Information Studies

Menlo College, Atherton, CA

2021

Graduate Certificate in Data Science & Design Thinking

Menlo College, Atherton, CA

2019

B.S. in Management Information Systems

Honors: Summa Cum Laude (3.9/4.0 GPA)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Fellow, Equitable AI Underwriters Lab.

Jun 2024–Present

Remote

- Conducted research on Community Based System Dynamics and Reinforcement Learning to build social knowledge with researchers, funders, journalists, and community stakeholders
- Built tools to power map and model the system dynamics of the AI Funding Ecosystem
- Co-facilitated community-based system dynamics workshops in Oakland.

Digital Library Assistant, UCLA Digital Library Program

Jan 2024–Oct 2024

Los Angeles, CA.

- Developed data model for Sinai Monastery digital objects project to migrate from JSON document storage to a PostgreSQL database.
- Led data migration and cleanup for the Palestinian Museum digital library partnership.
- Built Python scripts and documentation for processing of new archival materials and transcripts of oral histories

Creative Effectiveness Lead, Google US Creative Works

Feb 2022–Aug 2023

Playa Vista, CA.

- Consulted with large partners in retail and personal care to optimize existing creative content, including Nike, Walmart, Target, Amazon Prime Video, Peloton, Athleta, Sephora, eBay, Wayfair, and Advil.
- Designed and ran A/B tests to identify creative learnings, built internal tools for creative insights and trend analysis, and translated findings into actionable recommendations for brands.

Creator Insights Researcher, Google Area 120 – Rodeo

Dec 2019–Feb 2021

San Bruno, CA.

- Built tools and automation processes to support creator recruitment, GTM strategy across YouTube, and assist UXR with insights while product is in closed beta
- Led data analysis for quarterly reviews, pulling and analyzing data from +2,000 livestreams to support product development, GTM strategy, and content strategy materials for creators

Strategic Partner Manager - Creator Communities, YouTube

May 2019–May 2022

San Bruno, CA.

- Pitched and signed deals with 46 creators totaling over \$1M, managed relationships with creators performed channel optimizations, developed digital strategy, and secured brand deals
- Conducted research on Black creators' YouTube experience, partnering with Trust & Safety and User Research teams to inform policies and product development
- Technical Lead for Partner Impact Stories, a global repository of the partner facing team's best practices, case studies, and success stories. Managed all data pipelines and built web app used by our global team.

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Graduate Student Researcher and Technical Lead

Spring 2026–Present

Center For Resilience and Digital Justice Lab, UCLA

PI: Safiya Noble

Associate Instructor and Course Designer, University of California, Los Angeles

2025–2026

Course: CLUSTER 10C: Critical Introduction to Machine Learning & AI (Spring)

Teaching Associate, University of California, Los Angeles

2025–2026

Courses: CLUSTER 10A: Data, Justice, and Society (Fall); CLUSTER 10B: Data Justice, and Society (Winter)

Associate Instructor and Course Designer, University of California, Los Angeles

2024–2025

Course: CLUSTER 10C: The Long History of Computational Reason and Algorithmic Culture (Spring)

Teaching Associate, University of California, Los Angeles

2024–2025

Courses: CLUSTER 10A: Data, Justice, and Society (Fall); CLUSTER 10B: Data Justice, and Society (Winter)

PUBLICATIONS

Academic Publications

Alexander Williams and **Ngozi Harrison**. "Empowering Critical Thinking Using Experiential and Student-Centered Learning in the Age of AI: Lessons from Hip-Hop Pedagogy and Critical Information Studies." In *Artificial Intelligence and Transformative Pedagogies in the Digital Age*, Springer.

Oct 2026 (forthcoming)

Williams, Alexander and Harrison, Ngozi. "STUDENT-CENTERED LEARNING AND PEDAGOGY IN THE AGE OF AI". CELDA 2025, 409.

Nov 2025

Under Review

Alexander Williams and Ngozi Harrison. "Look What I Done for You: Ghosts, Data, and the Technology of Haunting". Digital Culture and Society

In Progress

Karl Bullock, Kareem Edouard, Iheanyi Amaraizu, **Ngozi Harrison**, Kevin Winstead, Rayvon Fouché. "Black Boys and Technology". University of Minnesota Press

Manuscripts in Preparation

Jonathan Givan and Ngozi Harrison. "Beyond the Limits of Noise: Seeing Black Boyhood Outside the Bounds of White Datafication"

In Progress

Stephanie T. Jones, Nina-Simone Edwards, **Ngozi Harrison**, Mouray Hutchinson, and Rayvon Fouché. *Artificial Intelligence and Marginality*.

In Progress

Other Publications and Writing

- Ngozi Harrison, "Critical Mathematics – a Reading List", *Feminist Center for Creative Work* September 2026
- Genius Amaraizu, Aaron Dial, Kareem Edouard, Rayvon Fouche, Jonathan Givan, **Ngozi Harrison**, James Holly Jr., Reginold Royston, and Kevin Winstead. "How the Tech Industry Fails Black Boys and How Community Can Lead the Way." *Successful Black Parenting Magazine*. August 2025
- Ngozi Harrison**. "How do we set the Black technical object free?" *The Observer*, an exhibition by Seneca Labs. Essay included in an edited collection. August 2023

ACADEMIC CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Conference Presentations

- Stephanie T. Jones, Nina-Simone Edwards, **Ngozi Harrison**, Mouray Hutchinson, Rayvon Fouché, PhD. "From Hypecells to Technoskepticists: Labor, Language, and Recursion amidst anti-Black AI imaginaries", AfroAlgorithms 2026. Lewiston, Maine. May 2026
- Alexander Williams and **Ngozi Harrison**. "Student-Centered Learning in the Age of AI." Conference Proceedings for the 22nd International Conference on Cognition and Exploratory Learning in Digital Age. Porto, Portugal. November 2025
- James L. Epps and **Ngozi Harrison**. "Investigating Rupture and Absence: A Conversation between Critical Archival Studies and Critical Data Studies." Association of Internet Researchers Conference 2025. Niteroi, Brazil. October 2025
- Ngozi Harrison**. "Fairness Hesitant: Machine Learning, Abstraction, and the Social Aspects of Mathematical Knowledge." 55th Annual Conference of the Association of Black Sociologists. Memphis, TN. October 2025
- Ngozi Harrison**. "Blackness, Mathematics, and Computation: Toward Black Computational Thought and Critical Technical Practice." Peer 2 Peer Mini-Conference, UCLA Center for Critical Internet Inquiry and Feminist Center for Creative Work. Los Angeles, CA. May 2025

Panels and Roundtables

- Ngozi Harrison (Organizer)**, James Epps, Jenaba Sow, Leslie Coney, J. Rosario-Turner, Sierra Talbert, Dominic Pearson . Graduate Student Panel. "Data Consciousness Reframing Blackness in Contemporary Print" with Tiffany Barber, Safiya Noble, Silas Munro, and Randa Hadi. Los Angeles, CA. June 2026
- Ngozi Harrison. "Machine Learning Hesitant: Du Bois and the Politics of Abstraction". Lightning Talk. Data Science Education Symposium. Los Angeles, CA. April 2026
- André Brock, Safiya Noble, Charlton McIlwain, Rianna Walcott, **Ngozi Harrison**, and Kevin Winstead (facilitator). "BLACK AND/AS AI." Critical Approaches to Black Media Culture Conference. New Orleans, LA. February 2026
- Geoffrey Bowker, Simone Browne, **Ngozi Harrison**, and Sasha Costanza-Chock, moderated by André Brock. "Universalism" panel at AI.Culture.Democracy.Now. workshop by AIAI Network. Atlanta, GA. September 2025
- Rayvon Fouché, Aaron Dial, Ron Eglash, Michael Bennett, Aria Halliday, Tonia Sutherland, and **Ngozi Harrison**. "Black Innovation." Panel at DISCO Network Summit. Ann Arbor, MI. June 2024
- Ngozi Harrison**. "On the Algorithmic Logics of Terror (Or Notes for the Catastrophe)." Paper presented at the 10:23 Fall Graduate Conference during the panel "Thinking Black Space: Desecration, Materiality, and the Visual Witness of Anti-Blackness," hosted by Yale University Religious Studies Department. New Haven, CT. September 2023

Poster Presentations

Ngozi Harrison, “Machine Learning Hesitant: W.E.B. Du Bois, Problem Framing, and the Politics of Abstraction.” International Meeting of the Psychometric Society 2026. Seoul, South Korea July 2026

GUEST LECTURES AND INVITED TALKS

Ngozi Harrison. “Infrastructure and Critical Code Studies.” Guest Lecture to Methods in Science and Technology Studies Doctoral Seminar, UCLA Information Studies Jan 2026

Ngozi Harrison. “Fairness in Machine Learning: A Sociotechnical Perspective.” Deanna Needell Research Group, UCLA Mathematics. June 2025

Safiya Noble and **Ngozi Harrison**. “The Politics of Search.” Joint lecture to Data Justice and Society course at the University of California, Los Angeles. February 2025

Ngozi Harrison. “A Conversation on Critical Approaches to AI and Pedagogy.” Lecture to Doctoral Thesis Writing course at Mills College at Northeastern University. Oakland, CA. August 2024

Workshops

AI and Marginality DISCO Jam Writing Workshop. DISCO Network. Chicago, IL. November 2025

Black Boys and Technology DISCO Jam Writing Workshop. DISCO Network. Chicago, IL. August 2025

Data & Society, “Digital Doppelgangers: A Workshop on our Digital Others.” May 2023

SERVICE & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Service to the Discipline and Profession

IEEE Technology and Society Magazine, Article Reviewer. Los Angeles, CA. August 2025

Networks and Affiliations

DISCO Network Research Affiliate. Mar 2025–Feb 2026

Humanity and Technoscience Lab Affiliate, Northwestern University Aug 2025 – Present

Association of Black Sociologists, Member. May 2025–Present

Association of Internet Researchers, Member. Sept 2023–Present

UAW 2865, Member. Sept 2023–Present

Alphabet Workers Union, Member. April 2021–August 2023

Awards & Fellowships

UCLA Eugene V. Cota-Robles Fellow. March 2023–Present

Center for Race and Digital Justice Fellow, Center for Race and Digital Justice. Dec 2023–July 2024

Technical Skills

Programming Languages/Packages:

Python, R, SQL, SciPy, scikit-learn, pandas, NumPy, HTML/CSS/JS, OpenRefine.